Osmosis

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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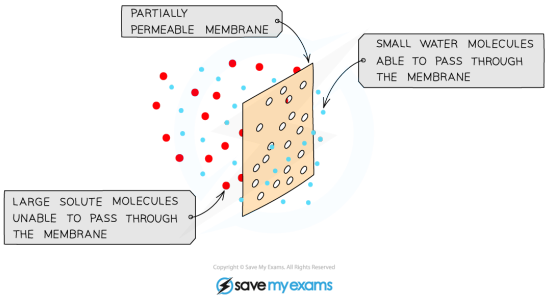
Osmosis

- All cells are surrounded by a cell membrane which is **partially permeable**
- **Water** can move in and out of cells by osmosis
- Osmosis is the diffusion of water molecules from a **dilute solution** (low solute concentration) to a **more concentrated solution** (high solute concentration) across a **partially permeable membrane**
- In doing this, water is moving down the **concentration gradient from where there is more water to where there is less**
- The cell membrane is partially permeable which means it allows **small molecules** (like water) through but not larger molecules (like solute molecules)



Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Note that for extended students, it is important to be able to explain the process of osmosis with reference to water potential gradients, as detailed in the revision note page titled 'Osmosis in Animals & Plants'

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